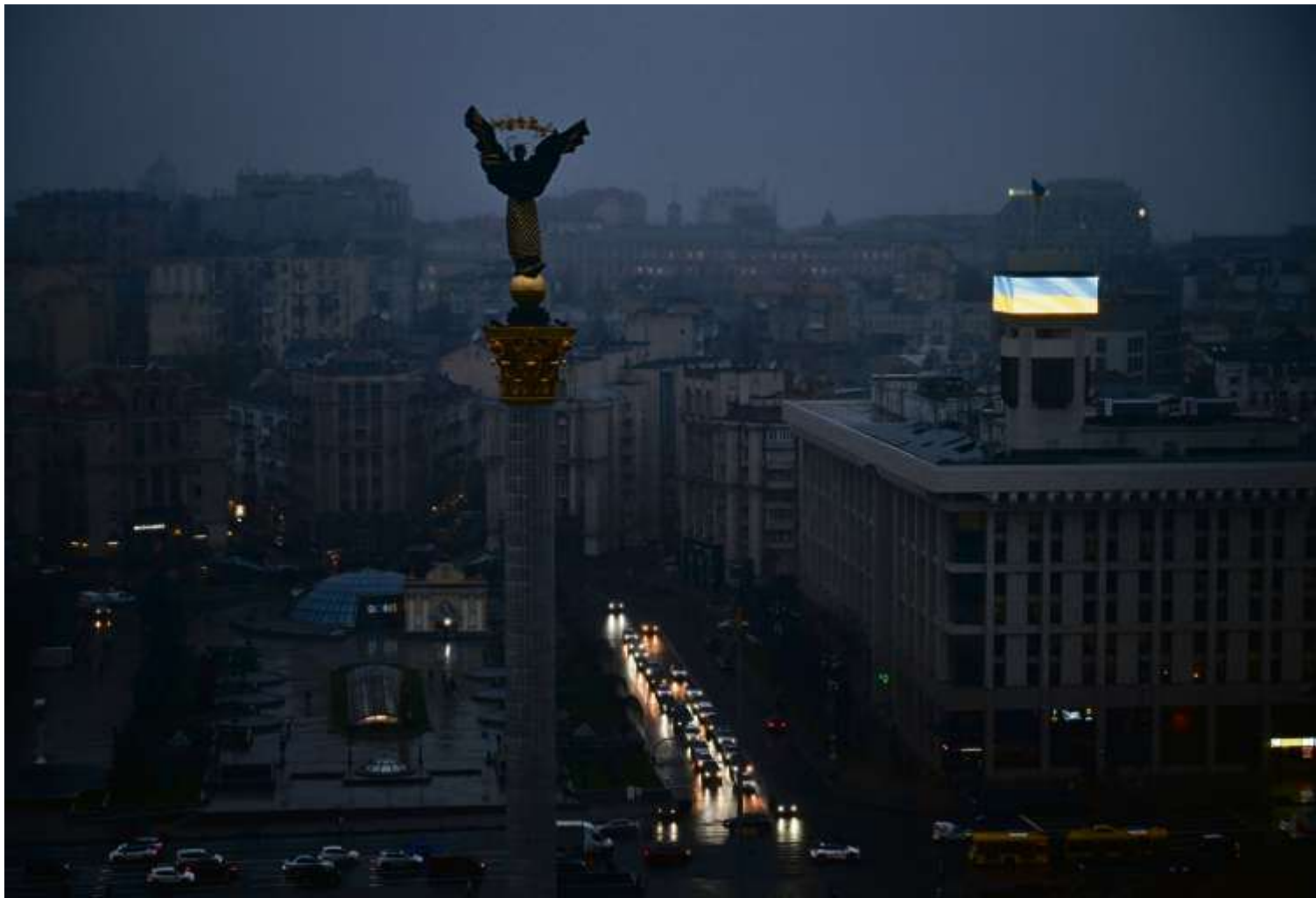


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SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 22, 2025

Zelensky foresees ‘difficult choice’



SERGEI GAPON/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Cars drove in Independence Square in Kyiv as a Ukrainian flag was displayed on a big screen during a power outage this week.

White Houses pushes for answer soon on its plan to end war with Russia



VLADYSLAV MUSIIENKO/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Residents stood in the cold at the site of a heavily damaged residential building following an air attack in Ternopil, Ukraine.

By Aurelien Breeden
and Cassandra Vinograd

NEW YORK TIMES

LONDON — President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine suggested Friday that his country’s alliance with the United States could be at a breaking point as the White House presses Ukraine to respond by Thanksgiving to its plan to end the war against Russia.

The 28-point proposal from the White House — which Ukraine has said was drafted without its involvement — would give Russia most of what it has asked for, including the surrender of Ukrainian territory and sharp limits on Ukraine’s military. The plan would require Ukraine to accept conditions that it and its European allies have long called unacceptable and tantamount to capitulation.

In a video address to the Ukrainian people Friday afternoon, Zelensky said his country was facing “one of the most difficult moments in our history.”

“Ukraine may soon find itself before a

UKRAINE, Page A5

Some Afghan migrants who helped US lose food aid

Waiting period added in spending bill causes confusion about eligibility

By Paul Heintz

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

BURLINGTON, Vt. — Four years after the Taliban returned to power in Afghanistan, Mariam and Mohammad finally reached their new home in September: this small, northerly city, some 6,500 miles from Kabul. By then, the young couple had exhausted their savings and gone into debt paying for visas and safe houses in Pakistan as they

sought safe passage to the United States.

“We have nothing,” Mohammad said. “We are going to build our life from scratch.”

Like many of the estimated 650 Afghans living in Vermont, Mariam and Mohammad came to the country on a Special Immigrant Visa, which is available to those who worked for the US during its wars in Afghanistan and Iraq. The couple

asked the Globe not to use their last names so as not to imperil relatives still in Afghanistan.

SIV recipients are granted green cards, or permanent resident status, upon arrival — and have had access to government assistance, such as the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, or food stamps.

Until now.

The One Big Beautiful Bill Act, which President Trump signed into law in July, cut off access to SNAP for 90,000 noncitizens who are in the country legally, according to the Congressional Budget Office.

Among them are refugees and those with asylum who have not had a green card for more than five years.

The status of SIV-holders from Iraq and Afghanistan is less clear. Ambiguous wording in the statute and a dearth of guidance from the US Department of Agriculture, which administers SNAP, have left states struggling to determine whether SIV-holders still qualify for the program.

Some states, Vermont among them, began removing Afghans and Iraqis from the rolls this fall, fearing

AFGHANS, Page A6

At Harvard, Sackler name stays on buildings

Students, others renew calls for removal following Purdue Pharma settlement

By Chris Serres

GLOBE STAFF

Harvard University has elected to keep the name of the deceased patriarch of the Sackler family on two of its campus buildings, despite years of protests and a new legal settlement that paves the way for institutions to remove the family name from buildings and programs.

A group of Harvard students and families of opioid victims this week renewed calls to remove the Sackler name from the buildings, in the wake of a multibillion-dollar plan approved by a federal bankruptcy judge that closes a long-running legal fight against the Sacklers and their company, Purdue Pharma, for their role in a decades-long opioid crisis that has claimed more than 900,000 lives.

The Sackler family, which built a massive fortune on the addictive painkiller OxyContin, agreed under the deal not to contest decisions by universities, museums, medical centers, and other institutions to remove their name. Under public pressure, at least 20 institutions around the globe — including the University of Oxford in the United Kingdom, Tufts University, the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York, and the Louvre Museum in Paris — have in recent years dropped the Sackler name from their walls and programs. Other institutions have canceled millions of dollars in donations.

“If ever there was a moment to remove the Sackler name, that moment is now,” said Nik

SACKLERS, Page A10

Denigrating wording in emails from ex-MIT scholar

Epstein files show doubts on women, Black children

By Kate Selig

GLOBE STAFF

Joscha Bach, a former MIT Media Lab researcher whose work there was funded by Jeffrey Epstein, questioned the intellectual development of Black children and women’s interest in math and science in emails to the disgraced financier in 2016, according to recently released documents from the US House Oversight Committee.

►Messages show depth of ties between Jeffrey Epstein and Noam Chomsky. B1.

The email chain included a discussion of famed linguist Noam Chomsky’s views on the biological basis of language but then veered into generalizations on race and gender, while also querying Epstein about his “political incorrectness.”

The release of the files delivers another blow to MIT’s effort to move past the fallout from Epstein’s ties to its renowned Media Lab. The Media Lab’s former director, Joi Ito, was revealed to have culti-

SCIENTIST, Page A7

A sweet reminder of days gone by

Friendly’s topiary still has a place on the Mass. Pike — and in our hearts

By Mark Shanahan

GLOBE STAFF

As you head west on the Massachusetts Turnpike, it appears unexpectedly on the side of a hill between the Palmer and Ludlow exits: a collection of hedges trimmed in a distinctive script that spells “Friendly Ice Cream.”

But the topiary, a botanical billboard that has been catching the eye of weary travelers for 50 years, is more than just a familiar landmark along the highway from Boston to the Berkshires.

It’s an artifact. Friendly’s is mostly a memory these days — hundreds of its restaurants have closed over the past three decades — but the manicured shrubs are healthier than ever. While kids and families in many towns can no longer crowd into a booth and gorge on Friendly’s sundaes and patty melts — served “the Friendly way,” between slices of grilled rye bread — the bushes are thriving.

The topiary isn’t just a living tribute to a once iconic New England brand, it’s also a whimsical reminder of bygone days when grandma would polish off a dish of Friendly’s butter

FRIENDLY’S, Page A10



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

The landmark Friendly Ice Cream topiary has been a fixture along the Massachusetts Turnpike since 1974, lasting through several iterations of ownership for the ice cream company.

President Trump and New York City Mayor-elect Zohran Mamdani had a cordial meeting at the White House, after lobbying labels like “communist” and “despot” at each other during Mamdani’s campaign. A6.

Gunmen attacked a Catholic boarding school in Nigeria and abducted more than 200 schoolchildren. A4.

Construction could resume in 2026 at the former South Weymouth Naval Air Station now



that the Massachusetts Legislature has approved an updated set of zoning and development guidelines for the sprawling 1,400-acre base property south of Boston. D1.

Sun and done

Saturday: Becoming sunny. High: 46-51. Low: 30-35.

Sunday: Becoming cloudy. High: 43-48. Low: 36-41.

Comics and Weather, D4-5. Obituaries, C9.

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